

VAULT

Admin Panel — Dispute Resolution

Developer Specification | v1.0 | Internal

Overview

This document specifies the admin panel to be built for Vault's dispute resolution workflow. It covers what to build at MVP stage, what to defer, and the complete end-to-end flow for resolving disputed transactions.

The admin panel is accessed only by the Vault team. It is not customer-facing.

1. Dispute Statuses

Every dispute record must have one of three statuses. These drive the admin view and filter logic.

Status	Meaning	Admin action needed?
Active	Just raised by buyer	Yes — review immediately
Under Review	Admin is investigating	Yes — in progress
Resolved	Decision passed	No — locked

⚠ Once status is set to Resolved, it must be locked permanently. No edits, no re-opening. Both action buttons (Refund / Credit) must be disabled and visually greyed out.

2. What to Build at MVP Stage

2.1 Keep — Core requirements

Dispute record view

- Transaction timeline — every state change with its exact timestamp, displayed chronologically. This is the primary tool for judging disputes.
- Seller's uploaded screen recording — video player embedded in the panel.
- Buyer's stated reason for dispute — plain text as submitted.
- Buyer's counter-evidence — file/image upload provided by buyer.
- Additional evidence uploaded by the seller (upon admin request after buyer disputed)
- All elements must be visible on one screen without switching tabs.

Messaging thread

- Messages can be handled over official mail

⚠ *Live chat can be added later.*

Dispute status control

- Status selector: Active → Under Review → Resolved. Admin manually progresses this.
- Status must be clearly visible for the admin at a glance.
- Active – newly created disputes
- Under review – dispute resolution in progress
- Resolved – dispute closed, decision passed and final (disabled until “Credit” or “Refund” is initiated)

Decision panel

- Written reason field — mandatory field that enables “REFUND” and “CREDIT” action button. Minimum 10 characters stating the investigation details, final decision and other relevant notes. This will be shared with both parties (buyer and seller) once submitted.
- REFUND button — triggers Razorpay refund to buyer's original payment source.

- CREDIT button — triggers RazorpayX payout to seller's bank account.
- Both buttons must show a confirmation modal before executing: 'You are about to [refund ₹X to buyer / pay ₹X to seller]. This is irreversible. Confirm?'
- Once either button is clicked and confirmed, both buttons are permanently disabled for that dispute record.

Outcome notifications

- On Refund: automated message to buyer — 'Your dispute has been reviewed. A refund of ₹X has been initiated to your original payment method. Please allow 5–7 business days.' Else, "Upon careful review of evidence submitted by both parties, you have forfeited the dispute. Payment of ₹X will be processed to seller (seller name)".
- On Credit: automated message to seller — 'Your dispute has been reviewed. Payment of ₹X will be credited to your bank account within 24–48 hours.' Else, "Upon careful review of evidence submitted by both parties, you have forfeited the dispute. Payment of ₹X will be refunded to buyer (buyer name)".
- Both parties notified simultaneously — neither should find out before the other.

Admin dashboard header

- Total active disputes (count)
- Total resolved this week (count)
- Total transaction volume this week (₹ value)

This is a simple 3-number header row. No charts or analytics required at this stage.

Dispute age indicator

- Every dispute record shows how long it has been open (e.g. '14 hours ago').
- Colour coding: green = under 24 hrs, amber = 24–36 hrs, red = over 36 hrs.
- This allows Vault to honour its 48-hour resolution commitment stated in T&C.

Notifications sent log

- A simple log on each transaction record showing every automated notification sent, to whom, and at what time.

- Purpose: when a user claims they 'never received a notification', admin can verify instantly.

3. End-to-End Dispute Flow

The sequence below describes every step from dispute creation to resolution.

#	Event	What happens
1	Buyer clicks NO on confirmation screen	Dispute record auto-created. Status → Active. Admin alerted.
2	Admin opens dispute	View: transaction timeline, seller evidence, buyer reason, counter-evidence (if any).
3	Admin requests clarification (if needed)	Post message to buyer or seller. They see it in their transaction screen. Their reply appears in the thread.
4	Admin makes decision	Type written reason (mandatory). Click Refund or Credit button.
5	System executes action	Razorpay refund or payout fires immediately. Both parties notified automatically.
6	Dispute locks	Status → Resolved. Buttons disabled. Record preserved. Decision is final.

⚠ Razorpay refunds cannot be reversed once initiated. The REFUND and CREDIT buttons must never fire without the confirmation modal. There is no undo.

4. Database Requirements

The following fields are required on the disputes table. Add to existing schema.

Field	Type	Notes
<code>transaction_id</code>	FK	Links to main transactions table
<code>status</code>	ENUM	Active Under Review Resolved
<code>buyer_reason</code>	TEXT	Submitted by buyer on raising dispute
<code>buyer_evidence_url</code>	VARCHAR	File URL if buyer uploads counter-evidence
<code>admin_decision_reason</code>	TEXT	Mandatory before Refund/Credit fires
<code>decision_type</code>	ENUM	REFUND CREDIT NULL (until decided)
<code>decided_at</code>	TIMESTAMP	When decision was passed
<code>decided_by</code>	VARCHAR	Admin user ID for accountability
<code>opened_at</code>	TIMESTAMP	When dispute was created — drives age indicator
<code>messages</code>	JSON / relation	Thread of admin ↔ buyer/seller messages

5. Razorpay Implementation Notes

Refund to buyer

- Use Razorpay Refunds API — refunds to original payment source (UPI, card, etc.).
- Instant refunds cost ₹9.43–₹17.69 per transaction. Standard refunds are free but take 5–7 days. Use standard for v1.
- API call: POST /v1/payments/{payment_id}/refund with amount in paise.

⚠ You cannot reverse a refund once initiated. Confirmation modal before execution is non-negotiable.

Payout to seller

- Use RazorpayX Payouts API — transfers to seller's registered bank account.
- Payout amount = ticket price minus Vault's 2.5% seller fee.
- Standard payout: T+1 business days. Instant payout: 0.20–0.30% additional fee.
- Use T+1 for v1.

6. Build Priority

Build in this order. Do not move to the next item until the current one is working correctly.

Priority	Item	Notes
P1	Dispute record view	Timeline + evidence + buyer reason on one screen
P1	Refund & Credit buttons	With confirmation modal — Razorpay integration
P1	Outcome notifications	Auto-notify both parties on decision
P2	Dispute status (3 states)	Active / Under Review / Resolved + locking
P2	Written reason field	Mandatory gate before buttons activate
P2	Dispute age indicator	Green / amber / red based on hours open
P3	Dashboard header	3 numbers: active disputes, resolved, volume
P3	Messaging thread	Admin ↔ buyer/seller message log
P3	Notifications sent log	Per-transaction record of all automated messages